

Tanish Karnala

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EDUCATION

The University of Georgia, Honors Program, Athens, GA May 2029

- Bachelor of Business Administration: Management Information Systems, Economics, Minor in International Affairs
- Honors Program (Top 5% of Class), Zell Miller Scholarship (Full Tuition)

Milton High School, Milton, GA

- Congressional Gold Medal; Presidential Volunteer Service Award (Gold), Atlanta Journal-Constitution Cup
- National Senate Page Program Semifinalist; Georgia Boys State Finalist; Governor's Honors Program Finalist

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

STEM@GTRI Research Program, Analyst, Atlanta, GA June 2024 – July 2024

- Accepted to Georgia Tech Research Institute's Electronic Systems Laboratory's paid research program (1.8% acceptance rate)
- Diagnosed and corrected a training-distribution mismatch in YOLOv8 to adapt a real-time detection model for aerial use
- Presented the cost-effectiveness of drones over legacy systems to GTRI faculty, GT Board of Directors, and 150+ attendees

Wildfire Predictive Modeling with Autonomous Drones, Researcher, Milton, GA August 2022 – May 2025

- Built a TensorFlow/TF Lite CNN for real-time wildfire image identification (98% accuracy) on a Raspberry Pi drone
- Developed a secondary model using historical wildfire and weather data to forecast regional risk (87% accuracy)
- Presented a TEDx Talk on the project; awarded 1st Place, GA Student Tech Competition (2023-24) and Science Fair

Housing Affordability & Economic Mobility, Researcher, Milton, GA August 2025–Present

- Built a two-phase econometric model analyzing 60+ housing-market drivers across 63 public datasets
- Phase 1: multivariate regression (adjusted $R^2 = 0.78$) identifying rent, housing supply, and income as unaffordability predictors
- Phase 2: XGBoost/ARIMA time-series forecasting (92% accuracy) projecting a 6% rise in unaffordability by 2030

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP & RELEVANT EXPERIENCES

Model United Nations, Member, Athens, GA September 2025 – Present

- Selected as 1 of 7 from ~200 applicants for the 7th best collegiate competitive Model UN team in the world
- Performed committee-specific economic analysis, consolidating research, and presenting solutions to global challenges
- Assisted in organizing two annual conferences for high schoolers and the collegiate circuit: UGAMUNC and ARCHMUNC

Arch Policy Institute, Analyst, Athens, GA September 2025 – Present

- Contributed to a non-partisan think tank addressing pressing policy challenges in Athens-Clarke County
- Attended Athens-Clarke County Commission meetings; summarized zoning mandates and presented findings at exhibition
- Leveraged R to build data visualizations of zoning and housing trends for policy briefs

DECA, Founder & President, Milton, GA August 2022 – May 2025

- Established Milton High School's DECA Chapter, a competitive club that prepares members for careers in business
- Grew the club from 5 to 80+ members in two years; recognized as 4th Fastest-Growing Chapter, GA State
- Organized seminars on financial literacy and preparedness for competitive events, coached 6 ICDC qualifiers

First Robotics, Co-Founder/Vice-President, Athens, GA May 2020 – May 2025

- Co-founded a nonprofit FRC robotics team; received the Rookie Inspiration Award at the 2022 FRC World Championship
- Initiated STEM outreach at local schools, YouTube videos (40,000+ views), and was recognized as a Dean's List Semifinalist
- Set multiple state records, led fundraising efforts (\$20,000+), and received several awards at the State and Regional Levels

Food4Lives, Fulton County Coordinator, Atlanta, GA August 2019 – May 2025

- Coordinated county-wide efforts to ease homelessness through food drives and personal protective equipment
- Advocated for addressing homelessness in my community by reaching out to community leaders and Congressmen
- Devoted 400+ volunteer hours organizing food, clothing, and supply drives across Fulton County

Professional Experience

Jupiter Gardens Primary Care, Intern, Jupiter, FL June – July 2026

- Support front-desk operations; observed how Medicaid/SSA paperwork disenrolls eligible disabled patients at 18
- Built a bilingual (EN/ES) tool that reads DCF, APD, and SSA notices to explain deadlines and next steps (Live demo)
- Grounded content in SSA data (55.7% initially denied at 18); built step-by-step prep for its Adult Function Report

Red Ventures Sophomore Summit, Analyst, Charlotte, NC April – May 2026

- Selected as one of 35 sophomores to attend a three-day, fully funded AI case competition at Red Ventures' HQ
- Pitched senior leadership on an AI-integrated solution to address user decline on the Lonely Planet Travel App

VDart Consulting, Junior Project Manager Intern, Alpharetta, GA January 2024 – May 2024

- Managed a team of 7 to launch an AI-powered HR service for Fortune 500 clients; led go-to-market strategy
- Directed competitor market research and pitched the product to potential clients, shaping a pricing strategy

SKILLS

Technical: Python, OpenCV, YOLOv8, TensorFlow, CAD, Raspberry Pi/Embedded Systems, Tableau, R, Excel

Business & Research: Econometric Modeling, Fundraising, Public Speaking, Market Research, Go-to-Market Strategy